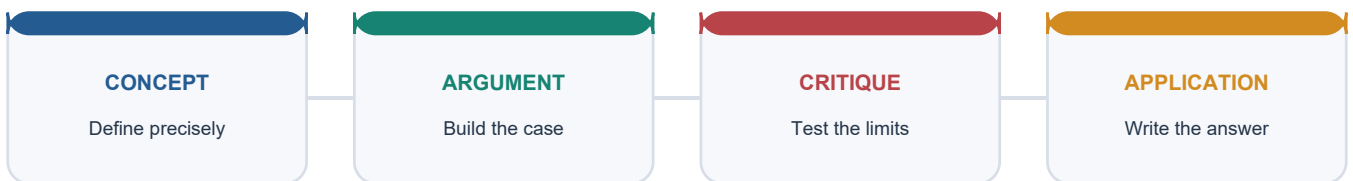


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A, item 6 | 32 MCQs with 128 option explanations, 14 solved PYQs, six original Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - Solved Practice Workbook

Standalone workbook. It reproduces the complete practice apparatus of the Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein learning package and can be worked without the teaching sessions. Syllabus, verbatim: *Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein : Defence of Commonsense; Refutation of Idealism; Logical Atomism; Logical Constructions; Incomplete Symbols; Picture Theory of Meaning; Sying and Showing* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section A, item 6. The official paper prints "**Sying**"; that printed wording is retained when the clause is quoted. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: doctrine on which the standard sources converge · ANALYSIS: analytical reconstruction for exam use · CAUTION: a live scholarly dispute. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads and the source term follows immediately in parentheses - *to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)*, *state of affairs (Sachverhalt)*, *sense (Sinn)*, *senseless (sinnlos)* against *nonsensical (unsinnig)*, *pictorial form (Form der Abbildung)*, *logical form (logische Form)*, *logical space (logischer Raum)*, *fundamental idea (Grundgedanke)*. Moore and Russell wrote in English; every English sentence attributed to Wittgenstein is a **translation**, and the *Tractatus* is cited by **decimal proposition number**, which is identical in every edition.

What this workbook contains

Component	Count
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	14
Supporting routed parts that name the trio but are owned elsewhere	3
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6

How to use it

1. Attempt the twenty-four core MCQs without notes, then read every option explanation, including those for the options you rejected. The key sequence is **unpatterned** - each answer was fixed independently - so no cycle can be guessed.
2. Attempt the eight remedial drills only after the core set; each targets a confusion that recurs in scripts every year, from *sinnlos* against *unsinnig* to the attribution boundary against Moore's ethics.
3. Write each PYQ under time before reading its solution, and check your script against the **demand-decoding table** rather than against the model answer's wording.
4. Read the three supporting routed parts for their **boundary notes**: each names a member of the trio while being owned by another syllabus item, and each carries an explicit statement of what this clause may and may not contribute.
5. Finish with the six original Mains models, two at each mark value, to test the same doctrine at three different lengths.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated, and no cycle such as ABCD can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Defence of Commonsense; Refutation of Idealism; Logical Atomism; Logical Constructions; Incomplete Symbols; Picture Theory of Meaning; Saying and Showing* - together with the attribution firewall, the three senses of analysis, Moore's truisms and the knowing/analysing distinction, comparative certainty, the three conditions of a rigorous proof and the gloss on "external", the act/object distinction and transparency with the exact boundary of the result, incomplete symbols, the three conjuncts of the description analysis, primary and secondary occurrence, the three puzzles, acquaintance and the Principle of Acquaintance, logically proper names, the supreme maxim and the four worked constructions, atomic facts and truth-functionality, negative facts, the ontology of 1.1 and *Sachverhalt*, and the pictorial/logical form contrast. The eight remedial drills attack the confusions that cost marks every year: *sinnlos* against *unsinnig*, bipolarity against bivalence, the general form and the N-operator, the derivation of saying/showing, the translation and numbering discipline at proposition 7, the boundary against verificationism, the attribution boundary against Moore's ethics, and the exact strength of the descriptions-to-atomism link.

MCQ 1. What the early analytic movement was revolting against

Which one of the following best identifies the doctrine that Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein were reacting against at Cambridge?

- A. The empiricism of Locke and Hume, with its derivation of all ideas from impressions of sense.
- B. The transcendental idealism of Kant, with its distinction between phenomena and the thing in itself.
- C. The scholastic metaphysics of substance and essence inherited from the Aristotelian tradition.
- D. British Absolute Idealism, with its internal relations, degrees of truth and demotion of ordinary judgement.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the British empiricists are a source the analytic writers draw on selectively - Russell inherits an interest in the given - rather than the local system they set out to dislodge.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant is a background presence, and Moore's 1939 lecture answers Kant's "scandal to philosophy" charge, but the Cambridge target was the monism of Bradley and McTaggart, not the critical philosophy.
- **C:** Incorrect: scholastic metaphysics is not the immediate opponent; the movement's polemic is directed at a living school whose members held chairs in the same universities.
- **D:** Correct: the doctrine of internal relations, degrees of truth and the treatment of the ordinary world as "appearance" is exactly what the revolt refuses.

Examiner trap 1: "Idealism" without a qualifier is fatal in this clause, because Moore's 1903 paper attacks the Berkeleyan *esse est percipi* equation while the movement's institutional opponent was Absolute Idealism. Name which idealism you mean.

MCQ 2. The three senses of "analysis"

Consider the following statements about what analysis is supposed to achieve in the three programmes.

1. In Moore, analysis clarifies what an ordinary judgement commits us to, and its incompleteness does not cancel knowledge of that judgement.
2. In Russell, analysis replaces an apparent designator by a quantified paraphrase that preserves truth-conditions without the ontological commitment.
3. In the early Wittgenstein, analysis is a method of comparing ordinary usages with one another in the language-games where they occur.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 1 is accurate, but statement 3 describes the later philosophy of the *Investigations* and is not what analysis means in the *Tractatus*.
- **B:** Correct: Moore's commitment-clarification and Russell's quantificational paraphrase are two of the three senses; the third is the resolution of propositions into truth-functions of elementary propositions.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 2 is accurate, but pairing it with statement 3 attributes to the early Wittgenstein a method he adopted only after abandoning the *Tractatus* programme.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 2 are correct, so including statement 3 imports language-games into a topic that does not own them.

Examiner trap 2: The word "analysis" is shared by all three men and means something different in each. A script that uses it without discrimination has recorded the movement's slogan and missed its content.

MCQ 3. Knowing a proposition and knowing its analysis

Which one of the following states the distinction Moore uses to protect ordinary knowledge in "A Defence of Common Sense"?

- A. That one may know a proposition to be true with certainty while the correct philosophical analysis of it remains doubtful.
- B. That one may believe a proposition firmly while lacking the evidence that would convert the belief into knowledge.
- C. That one may understand the words of a proposition while failing to grasp the concept those words express.
- D. That one may accept a proposition on testimony while being unable to verify it through one's own experience.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the truth of "I have two hands" is certain, while what a material object ultimately is may remain an unfinished philosophical question - and the sceptic's inference from the second to a denial of the first is a confusion of levels.
- **B:** Incorrect: Moore's distinction is not between belief and knowledge at all; he insists on the word "know", and it is the *analysis*, not the epistemic status, that he allows to remain doubtful.
- **C:** Incorrect: a gap between words and concept is a problem about understanding; Moore's point concerns two different questions about a proposition that is already understood.
- **D:** Incorrect: testimony and personal verification play no part in the argument, which is about the relation between knowing a truth and analysing it.

Examiner trap 3: Candidates often render this distinction as "knowing versus believing", which destroys the argument: Moore's whole strategy depends on the analysis being doubtful while the knowledge is not.

MCQ 4. The comparative-certainty principle

Which one of the following correctly states the principle on which Moore's defence of common sense rests?

- A. A truism is immune from criticism because a sufficiently large number of competent speakers accept it without hesitation.
- B. A truism is self-evident in the strict sense, so that its denial is a formal contradiction discoverable by reflection alone.
- C. A philosophical argument overturns a truism only if every premiss of that argument is more certain than the truism it denies.
- D. A philosophical argument overturns a truism only if it can be reconstructed as a valid deduction from premisses of natural science.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: popularity plays no role whatever. Moore's list is a philosophical proposal about what he and others know, not a survey of what people happen to believe.
- **B:** Incorrect: Moore does not claim self-evidence or formal indubitability; the truisms are contingent propositions about the world, and he claims to know them rather than to prove them.
- **C:** Correct: the argument is a weighing of credentials, and its empirical claim is that no sceptical or idealist premiss has ever met the condition.
- **D:** Incorrect: no appeal to scientific derivation appears in Moore's argument, which is conducted entirely through the comparison of certainties.

Examiner trap 4: Presenting comparative certainty as an appeal to common opinion converts a dialectical principle into a fallacy of popularity - and invites the objection Moore was careful to avoid.

MCQ 5. Moore's conditions for a rigorous proof

Consider the following as conditions Moore himself lays down for a rigorous proof in "Proof of an External World".

1. The premiss must be different from the conclusion, so that the argument is not circular.
2. The premiss must be known, and not merely believed or assumed.
3. The premiss must itself have been proved by a prior argument of the same rigour.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: condition 1 is Moore's, but condition 3 is the very requirement he rejects, since it would generate a regress in which nothing is ever proved.
- **B:** Correct: difference of premiss from conclusion and knowledge of the premiss are two of the three conditions; the third is that the conclusion must follow.
- **C:** Incorrect: condition 2 is Moore's, but attaching condition 3 makes the proof fail by a standard Moore explicitly denies is required.
- **D:** Incorrect: conditions 1 and 2 are correct, so including condition 3 misrepresents the concession that gives the lecture its philosophical interest.

Examiner trap 5: Moore concedes that he cannot prove "here is one hand" and treats the concession as harmless. A script that reports the concession as a defect has missed his argument that a proof requires a *known* premiss, not a *proved* one.

MCQ 6. Why the hands entail an external world

In Moore's proof, what makes the step from "here is one hand" to "an external world exists" a valid inference rather than a leap?

- A. The premiss is asserted with a degree of confidence that no sceptical consideration has ever been able to reduce.
- B. The premiss is confirmed by the concurring perceptual reports of the audience present at the British Academy lecture.
- C. The premiss belongs to the list of truisms already defended in the earlier paper of 1925 on common sense.
- D. The premiss concerns a hand, and Moore has glossed "external" as "met with in space", which a hand is.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: confidence is what makes the premiss *known* on Moore's account, but confidence alone cannot make an inference valid; validity requires the definitional link.
- **B:** Incorrect: no appeal to corroborating witnesses occurs, and the proof would be unaffected if Moore were alone.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two papers execute one strategy but are separate arguments; the 1939 inference works through the gloss on "external", not through membership of the 1925 list.
- **D:** Correct: "external to our minds" is explained as "things met with in space", so the existence of a hand analytically yields the existence of an external thing.

Examiner trap 6: Scripts that narrate the gesture without the gloss leave the inference unexplained. The definition is the load-bearing step, and it costs one clause.

MCQ 7. The structure of the refutation of idealism

Which one of the following reconstructs the central argument of Moore's "The Refutation of Idealism"?

- A. Since perception is causally dependent on physical stimulation of the sense organs, its objects must be physical rather than mental.
- B. Since the idealist cannot produce a coherent account of unperceived objects, the burden of proof falls on him rather than on the realist.
- C. Since the sensations of blue and green share consciousness and differ in their objects, the act of awareness cannot be identical with its object.
- D. Since ordinary language distinguishes seeing from what is seen, the idealist's usage departs from established linguistic practice.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Moore's argument is not causal and makes no appeal to physiology; it turns on what must be present in experience for two sensations to be comparable at all.
- **B:** Incorrect: burden-shifting is the strategy of the common-sense papers; the 1903 paper offers a positive structural argument rather than a redistribution of proof.
- **C:** Correct: the common element and the variable element cannot both be supplied if act and object are one, which is precisely the identification *esse est percipi* requires.
- **D:** Incorrect: an appeal to ordinary usage is a later analytic move; Moore argues from the structure of sensation, not from linguistic convention.

Examiner trap 7: The blue-green comparison is an argument, not an illustration. Reporting it as an example of the distinction, rather than as the reason for drawing it, loses the substance of the paper.

MCQ 8. The transparency or diaphanous thesis

What role does the transparency of consciousness play in Moore's refutation of idealism?

- A. It explains why the act of awareness is persistently overlooked, and so why act and object are so easily conflated.
- B. It establishes that the objects of awareness continue to exist during the intervals when nobody is perceiving them.
- C. It shows that introspection is an infallible source of knowledge concerning one's own present mental states.
- D. It demonstrates that consciousness has no intrinsic character of its own and is therefore a mere logical fiction.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: attention passes through the act to the object, so the act seems elusive - and Moore's point is that elusiveness is not absence.
- **B:** Incorrect: unperceived existence is exactly what the paper does *not* establish; the act/object distinction blocks an identification without proving independence.
- **C:** Incorrect: no claim of introspective infallibility is made, and the argument would be weakened rather than strengthened by one.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the conclusion some later philosophers of mind draw *against* Moore from the same observation; Moore holds that the act is real though hard to notice.

Examiner trap 8: Transparency is a diagnosis of the idealist's error, not a premiss of the refutation. Treating it as the argument leaves the answer resting on an introspective report Moore himself concedes is difficult.

MCQ 9. The exact scope of Moore's result

Consider the following claims about what "The Refutation of Idealism" achieves.

1. It shows that the *esse est percipi* argument does not establish idealism.
2. It shows that objects of sensation continue to exist when they are not being sensed.
3. It leaves Absolute Idealism untouched, since that doctrine does not argue from the perceptual equation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: claim 1 is right, but claim 2 overstates the result - distinguishing the object from the act does not by itself show that the object can exist unsensed.
- **B:** Correct: one argument for idealism is blocked, and Hegelian Absolute Idealism, resting on internal relations and the incompleteness of finite determinations, is not addressed.
- **C:** Incorrect: claim 3 is right, but claim 2 attributes to Moore a conclusion he explicitly does not draw in this paper.
- **D:** Incorrect: claims 1 and 3 are correct, so including claim 2 converts a bounded refutation into an unargued realism.

Examiner trap 9: "Moore refutes idealism" is the most frequently overclaimed sentence in this clause. He refutes an argument, and saying which argument is the difference between a competent and a strong script.

MCQ 10. What makes a symbol incomplete

Which one of the following correctly defines an incomplete symbol in Russell's sense?

- A. An expression with no meaning in isolation, defined only through rules giving the meaning of whole sentences containing it.
- B. An expression whose meaning is fixed by ostension, so that it cannot be understood without a present sample.
- C. An expression that fails to designate anything, and which therefore renders any sentence containing it meaningless.
- D. An expression whose meaning varies with the context of utterance, as with indexical and demonstrative terms.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this is the doctrine of contextual definition taken over from *Principia Mathematica*; the symbol contributes systematically to whole sentences and disappears on analysis.
- **B:** Incorrect: ostensive definition characterises Russell's logically proper names, which are the opposite case - symbols that *do* designate directly.
- **C:** Incorrect: an empty description makes its sentence **false**, not meaningless; avoiding meaninglessness is precisely the theory's achievement.
- **D:** Incorrect: context-sensitivity of indexicals is a different phenomenon; an incomplete symbol has no meaning of its own in any context.

Examiner trap 10: "Incomplete" is repeatedly read as "meaningless". Write the words "in isolation" and the error cannot occur.

MCQ 11. The analysis of a definite description

According to the theory of descriptions, "The F is G" asserts which combination of claims?

- A. That whatever is F is also G, and that at least one thing is G.
- B. That something is F, that something is G, and that the two are compatible.
- C. That the speaker presupposes an F and predicates G of it without asserting existence.
- D. That at least one thing is F, that at most one thing is F, and that it is G.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is a universally quantified conditional with an existential rider; it drops uniqueness entirely and so cannot capture the force of the definite article.
- **B:** Incorrect: existence for each predicate separately, plus compatibility, is far weaker than the analysis and would make "The F is G" true whenever unrelated F's and G's happened to exist.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is Strawson's rival account of 1950, on which existence is presupposed rather than asserted - Russell's whole point is that it is asserted.
- **D:** Correct: existence, uniqueness and predication, conjoined - formally $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$.

Examiner trap 11: Uniqueness is the conjunct most often dropped. Without it the analysis renders "the" as "a", and the definite article's entire contribution disappears.

MCQ 12. "The golden mountain is very high"

On Russell's analysis, what is the correct verdict on the sentence "The golden mountain is very high"?

- A. It is meaningless, since its grammatical subject fails to pick out any object in the world.
- B. It is neither true nor false, since the existence it presupposes is not satisfied.
- C. It is false, since the existence conjunct of its analysis is unsatisfied.
- D. It is true of a subsisting object, since we plainly understand what the phrase refers to.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: meaningfulness is what the theory is constructed to avoid, and it conflicts with the plain fact that competent speakers understand the sentence.
- **B:** Incorrect: a truth-value gap is Strawson's position, not Russell's; on the quantificational analysis the sentence has a determinate truth-value.
- **C:** Correct: the conjunction fails at its first conjunct because nothing is a golden mountain, so the whole sentence is false, and no golden mountain need subsist for it to be understood.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is Meinong's route, and the golden mountain is his own stock example; Russell's analysis is designed precisely to avoid populating the world with such objects.

Examiner trap 12: Writing that the sentence is "meaningless" reverses the theory's headline result. The examinable formula is *false*, *not meaningless*, and *no Meinongian object*.

MCQ 13. Primary and secondary occurrence

Which one of the following correctly explains Russell's treatment of "The King of France is not bald"?

- A. On the primary occurrence the description takes wide scope and the sentence is false; on the secondary occurrence the negation takes wide scope and it is true.
- B. On the primary occurrence the sentence is true because negation removes the existence claim; on the secondary occurrence it is false because it reinstates it.
- C. On both occurrences the sentence is false, because the existence claim is unsatisfied however the negation is placed within it.
- D. On both occurrences the sentence lacks a truth-value, because scope cannot be assigned where the description is empty.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: with the description taking wide scope the sentence asserts that exactly one King of France exists and is not bald, which is false; with negation taking wide scope it denies that exactly one bald King exists, which is true.
- **B:** Incorrect: the truth-values are inverted here - it is the *secondary* occurrence, with negation outside, that yields truth.
- **C:** Incorrect: this collapses the scope distinction and therefore loses the solution to the excluded-middle puzzle, which is exactly what the distinction is for.
- **D:** Incorrect: truth-value gaps belong to the presuppositional account; on Russell's analysis every well-formed sentence receives a value.

Examiner trap 13: Scope is treated as an optional technicality and then omitted. It is the *solution* to one of Russell's three advertised puzzles, so omitting it removes a third of the case for the theory.

MCQ 14. The three puzzles

Which one of the following is **not** among the three puzzles Russell claims the theory of descriptions resolves?

- A. How a negative existential statement can be true without referring to the thing whose existence it denies.
- B. How the law of excluded middle can hold for a sentence containing a description that nothing satisfies.
- C. How a general term can apply to indefinitely many individuals without naming a universal that they share.
- D. How substitution of an identical can fail inside a report of what someone wished to know.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect as an answer, because negative existentials *are* one of the three; the analysis makes the denial the negation of an existence-and-uniqueness claim.
- **B:** Incorrect as an answer, because excluded middle *is* one of the three; it is resolved by the primary/secondary scope distinction.
- **C:** Correct: the problem of universals is a separate issue in Russell's philosophy, addressed through his realism about universals, and is not one of the three puzzles of "On Denoting".
- **D:** Incorrect as an answer, because substitutivity *is* one of the three; George IV's curiosity about the author of *Waverley* is Russell's own illustration.

Examiner trap 14: The three puzzles are the theory's advertisement - one device solving three independent problems. Substituting a fourth, unrelated problem for one of them suggests the list has been half-remembered.

MCQ 15. The Principle of Acquaintance

Which one of the following states Russell's Principle of Acquaintance as given in *The Problems of Philosophy*?

- A. Every proposition that is true must correspond to some fact with which we could in principle become acquainted.
- B. Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted.
- C. Every object of knowledge must be either a sense-datum or something inferred by strict deduction from sense-data.
- D. Every name in a logically perfect language must be correlated with a particular that endures through change.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the principle constrains **understanding**, not truth, and it says nothing about what facts a true proposition must correspond to.
- **B:** Correct: this is the sentence itself, from Chapter 5, and it is the constraint that makes the theory of descriptions epistemically necessary rather than merely convenient.
- **C:** Incorrect: this describes a strict foundationalist theory of knowledge; Russell's principle is about the constituents of understood propositions, and acquaintance extends to universals as well as sense-data.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is a claim about logically proper names in an ideal notation, which is a consequence Russell draws rather than the principle he states.

Examiner trap 15: Quoting the principle as a constraint on truth rather than on understanding destroys the argument that follows, since the Bismarck problem is a problem about how a proposition can be *understood*.

MCQ 16. The objects of acquaintance

Which one of the following lists items that Russell counts among the objects of acquaintance in this phase of his philosophy?

- A. Physical objects, other minds, past events and the theoretical entities of physics.
- B. Propositions, facts, states of affairs and the logical constants that connect them.
- C. Material substances, their primary qualities and the causal powers by which they act.
- D. Sense-data, memory data, introspective data of one's own mental states, and universals.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: every item listed is known **by description** precisely because it is not directly presented; that is the contrast the distinction is built to mark.
- **B:** Incorrect: facts and states of affairs are what propositions answer to, and the logical constants are explicitly denied representative status by Wittgenstein; neither is an object of Russellian acquaintance.
- **C:** Incorrect: material substances and causal powers are inferred or constructed on Russell's account, not met without inference.
- **D:** Correct: and the inclusion of **universals** is the point worth flagging, since it is a substantial Platonic concession for a philosopher in the empiricist line.

Examiner trap 16: Omitting universals from the list makes Russell look like a strict sense-datum empiricist and removes the one item that shows where he breaks with Berkeley's nominalism.

MCQ 17. Logically proper names

Which one of the following is correct about logically proper names in Russell's austere phase?

- A. Ordinary proper names such as "Bismarck" qualify, because they are learned by direct introduction to their bearers.
- B. Definite descriptions qualify whenever they succeed in picking out exactly one object in the actual world.
- C. Only demonstratives such as "this" and "that", used of what is presently given, are serious candidates.
- D. Only the names of universals qualify, since universals alone are available to every thinker at every time.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: ordinary proper names are analysed as **disguised descriptions**, which is exactly the doctrine Kripke's modal argument later attacks.
- **B:** Incorrect: a description that uniquely applies is still contextually eliminated; success in picking something out does not convert a quantifier into a name.
- **C:** Correct: the class shrinks almost to nothing and varies with the speaker and the moment, and Russell was fully aware how restrictive this is.
- **D:** Incorrect: universals are objects of acquaintance, but Russell does not restrict genuine names to their labels; the demonstratives are his standard candidates.

Examiner trap 17: Candidates who read "logically proper name" as "genuine surname" invert the doctrine. The point is that almost no ordinary name qualifies.

MCQ 18. The supreme maxim

Which one of the following is Russell's supreme maxim in scientific philosophising?

- A. Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities.
- B. Wherever possible, replace an ambiguous ordinary sentence by a sentence of an ideal formal notation.
- C. Wherever possible, prefer the hypothesis that postulates the smallest number of unobserved causes.
- D. Wherever possible, resolve a philosophical dispute by determining how the disputed words are ordinarily used.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: it is Russell's own formulation, and it converts Ockham's razor from a slogan into a working procedure applied to inference.
- **B:** Incorrect: the ideal-notation programme is a related commitment, but the maxim is specifically about substituting construction for inference, not about regimenting ambiguity.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is a general principle of theoretical parsimony about causes; Russell's maxim is about the *entities a philosophical analysis must posit*.
- **D:** Incorrect: appeal to ordinary use is the method of later ordinary-language philosophy, and it is at odds with Russell's readiness to correct ordinary grammar.

Examiner trap 18: The maxim is short, quotable and dated 1914. Paraphrasing it loosely wastes the easiest verbatim mark in the Russell half of this clause.

MCQ 19. Constructions and atoms

Which one of the following correctly contrasts logical constructions with logical atoms?

- A. Constructions are the simples that analysis discovers, while atoms are the complexes that analysis dissolves.
- B. Constructions are objects of acquaintance, while atoms are objects known only by description.
- C. Constructions are found in mathematics alone, while atoms belong to the analysis of empirical propositions.
- D. Constructions add no further entity and are contextually defined, while atoms are the residue analysis seeks.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the roles are exactly reversed; it is constructions that analysis dissolves and atoms that it is looking for.
- **B:** Incorrect: acquaintance and description classify *knowledge of things*, not the construction/atom contrast, and physical objects are constructions yet known by description.
- **C:** Incorrect: numbers are indeed constructed, but so are tables, nations and points of space; the maxim is deliberately general.
- **D:** Correct: constructions receive contextual definitions and posit nothing extra, while atoms are what would remain when every construction has been removed.

Examiner trap 19: Constructions are frequently described as "fictions". We say **true** things about tables and nations; what is denied is an additional entity, not the truth of the sentences.

MCQ 20. What "atomic" means in "atomic fact"

Which one of the following correctly explains Russell's use of "atomic"?

- A. An atomic fact is one whose constituents are too small to be perceived without instrumental assistance.
- B. An atomic fact contains no other facts as constituents, though it does contain particulars and universals.
- C. An atomic fact is one that cannot be expressed in language and can therefore only be shown.
- D. An atomic fact is one whose truth is knowable a priori and independently of all sense experience.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the physical reading the 1918 lectures explicitly disown - the atoms are the "last residue in analysis", and they are logical, not microscopic.
- **B:** Correct: a particular exemplifying a quality, or particulars standing in a relation; "atomic" marks the absence of *facts* inside, not the absence of constituents.
- **C:** Incorrect: atomic facts are precisely what atomic propositions state; the sayable/showable boundary is Wittgenstein's, and it does not classify Russell's atomic facts as unsayable.
- **D:** Incorrect: atomic facts are contingent and are known, when they are known, through experience; apriority plays no part in the definition.

Examiner trap 20: Reading "atomic" as "partless" is as damaging as reading it as "physical". An atomic fact has constituents; what it lacks is facts among them.

MCQ 21. Truth-functionality and the connectives

Which one of the following follows from Russell's claim that molecular propositions are truth-functions of atomic ones?

- A. No additional fact in the world corresponds to the connectives "and" or "or".
- B. Every molecular proposition can be shown to be either a tautology or a contradiction.
- C. Every atomic proposition can be derived from some molecular proposition by analysis.
- D. No molecular proposition can be false if all of its atomic components are true.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the truth-value of the molecule is fixed by the atoms plus the connective, so the connective needs no ontological counterpart - a substantial economy.
- **B:** Incorrect: most molecular propositions are contingent; tautology and contradiction are the limiting cases, not the general case.
- **C:** Incorrect: the direction of construction runs the other way, from atoms to molecules; atomic propositions are the base, not the derived layer.
- **D:** Incorrect: "p and not-q" is false when p and q are both true, so truth of the components does not guarantee truth of the molecule.

Examiner trap 21: The economy is the point. A script that states truth-functionality without drawing the ontological consequence has described a truth-table instead of an argument.

MCQ 22. Negative facts

Why does Russell reluctantly admit negative facts into his ontology?

- A. Because the law of excluded middle requires every proposition to have a determinate truth-value.
- B. Because negation is a logical constant that must stand for something if the notation is to be interpreted.
- C. Because sense-data are sometimes absent, and their absence must be recorded in the inventory of the world.
- D. Because a true negative proposition seems to require something in the world to make it true.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: excluded middle constrains truth-values, not truth-makers, and Russell's difficulty is specifically about what makes a true negation true.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is close to the view Wittgenstein denies at 4.0312 when he says the logical constants are not representatives; Russell's motive is truth-making, not the interpretation of a symbol.
- **C:** Incorrect: absent sense-data are an epistemological matter; the problem concerns the ontological ground of true negative propositions such as "Socrates is not alive".
- **D:** Correct: to preserve a direct truth-making relation Russell accepts that the non-obtaining of a positive state is itself something - and he treats the admission as a cost.

Examiner trap 22: Wittgenstein avoids negative facts because the **totality** of obtaining states determines which possible states do not obtain. Attributing negative facts to the *Tractatus* merges the two atomisms at exactly the point where they diverge most sharply.

MCQ 23. The opening ontology of the *Tractatus*

Which one of the following correctly reports the opening ontological claims of the *Tractatus*?

- A. The world is the totality of objects, and facts are the ways in which we describe them.
- B. The world is the totality of facts, and a state of affairs is a combination of objects.
- C. The world is the totality of propositions, and objects are what makes them meaningful.
- D. The world is the totality of sense-data, and facts are constructions out of them.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this reverses 1.1, which insists that the world is facts and **not** things, and makes facts linguistic rather than worldly.
- **B:** Correct: 1.1 and 2.01 taken together - a complete list of objects would leave undecided how things stand, and only configurations settle that.
- **C:** Incorrect: propositions depict the world; identifying the world with propositions collapses the very relation the picture theory explains.
- **D:** Incorrect: sense-data belong to Russell's phenomenalist phase; Tractarian objects are logical simples characterised by their possibilities of combination.

Examiner trap 23: ANALYSIS: *Sachverhalt* is "atomic fact" in Ogden/Ramsey and "state of affairs" in Pears-McGuinness. Alternating between the two renderings within one answer looks like uncertainty about the text.

MCQ 24. Pictorial form and logical form

Which one of the following correctly distinguishes pictorial form from logical form?

- A. Pictorial form belongs to visual representations, while logical form belongs to sentences of a written language.
- B. Pictorial form is the arrangement of names, while logical form is the arrangement of the objects named.
- C. Pictorial form is what a picture must share with reality in its own medium; logical form is shared by every picture whatever.
- D. Pictorial form is grasped by the senses, while logical form is grasped by an act of pure intellectual intuition.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: pictorial form is not restricted to the visual - a musical score shares acoustic form - and logical form is not restricted to written language.
- **B:** Incorrect: this describes the correlation of elements within a single picture, not the contrast between the two kinds of form.
- **C:** Correct: a spatial model shares spatial form, a score shares acoustic form, and every picture, in any medium, shares logical form - which is why a proposition can depict any fact whatever.
- **D:** Incorrect: no faculty psychology is involved; the distinction concerns what must be common between representation and represented, not how we come to know it.

Examiner trap 24: The 2022 paper asks both whether the two differ **and** how logical form defines the language-world relation. Answering only the first half leaves half the question untouched.

MCQ 25. Remedial - sinnlos against unsinnig

Which one of the following correctly classifies the two ways in which a sentence can fail to say something in the *Tractatus*?

- A. Tautologies and metaphysical sentences are both nonsensical, since neither states a contingent fact about the world.
- B. Tautologies are nonsensical, while metaphysical sentences are senseless but well formed within the symbolism.
- C. Tautologies are false in every possible situation, while metaphysical sentences are true in every possible situation.
- D. Tautologies are senseless but well formed, while metaphysical sentences are nonsensical and depict nothing.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it erases the distinction the text insists on - tautologies belong to the symbolism and show logic's scaffolding, whereas metaphysical sentences never enter logical space.
- **B:** Incorrect: the two labels are exchanged, and the resulting classification makes metaphysics better placed than logic.
- **C:** Incorrect: tautologies are **true** under every truth-condition, and contradictions false under every one; metaphysical sentences have no truth-conditions at all.
- **D:** Correct: *sinnlos* for tautology and contradiction, *unsinnig* for the metaphysical pseudo-proposition - the most frequently tested discrimination in the *Tractatus*.

Examiner trap 25: Treating the two words as synonyms also opens the door to the verificationist misreading, because it suggests the *Tractatus* dismisses logic and metaphysics on one and the same ground.

MCQ 26. Remedial - bipolarity against bivalence

Which one of the following states the bipolarity requirement correctly?

- A. Every proposition is either true or false, and no proposition is both true and false at once.
- B. Every proposition has a truth-value that is determined once the meanings of its constituent words are fixed.
- C. A proposition has sense only if it is capable of being true and also capable of being false.
- D. A proposition has sense only if some procedure exists by which its truth could in principle be established.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is **bivalence**, which tautologies satisfy perfectly well while still failing bipolarity, since a tautology cannot be false.
- **B:** Incorrect: this describes determinacy of sense rather than bipolarity, and it would not exclude a sentence that could not possibly be false.
- **C:** Correct: both poles must be genuinely available, which is why tautologies and contradictions are *sinnlos* and why depicting requires the possibility of misdepicting.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the verification principle of the Vienna Circle, which belongs to the next syllabus item and is not the *Tractatus*'s criterion.

Examiner trap 26: Bipolarity is the point at which a *Tractatus* answer most easily slides into Topic 07. The test is whether a possible situation is depicted, never whether it can be checked.

MCQ 27. Remedial - the general form and the N-operator

In the general form of the proposition, $[p, \xi, N(\xi)]$, what does the N-operator do?

- A. It applies joint negation to a selected set of propositions, asserting that none of them is true.
- B. It applies material implication between two selected propositions, asserting that the first entails the second.
- C. It applies existential generalisation to a propositional function, asserting that the function has a value.
- D. It applies necessity to a selected proposition, asserting that it holds in every possible configuration.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: from joint negation alone one obtains $\neg p$ as $N(p)$, $p \vee q$ as $N(N(p,q))$ and $p \& q$ as $N(N(p),N(q))$ - a single operation generating every truth-function.
- **B:** Incorrect: implication is one of the truth-functions **derived** from N, not the operation itself.
- **C:** Incorrect: quantification is handled through sets of values of propositional functions, and the adequacy of that treatment for infinite domains is disputed; it is not what N means.
- **D:** Incorrect: modal notions are not primitive in the *Tractatus*, and treating N as a necessity operator misdescribes a truth-functional device.

Examiner trap 27: The point of proposition 6 is that logic needs **no primitive propositions and no logical objects** - Wittgenstein's decisive break with Russell and Frege. Reproducing the schema without that consequence wastes it.

MCQ 28. Remedial - why saying and showing is forced

Which one of the following gives Wittgenstein's reason for holding that logical form cannot be said?

- A. Because logical form is a fact of such generality that no finite proposition could state it completely.
- B. Because any picture of logical form would already have to possess logical form, so no depiction from outside is possible.
- C. Because logical form is known only through mystical experience, which by its nature resists linguistic formulation.
- D. Because logical form varies from one language to another, so no single statement of it could be universally correct.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the obstacle is not the size or generality of the task but the structural impossibility of a standpoint outside representation.
- **B:** Correct: depiction presupposes shared form, so the sharing cannot itself be depicted, and a regress threatens any attempt to state it.
- **C:** Incorrect: the mystical shows itself (6.522), but it is a **consequence** of the boundary rather than the ground of it; the argument is logical, not experiential.
- **D:** Incorrect: logical form is precisely what is **not** language-relative - it is the form of all possible representation.

Examiner trap 28: "Is he justified?" asks about the derivation. A script that lists sayable and showable items without deriving the distinction has answered a question about content with a question about inventory.

MCQ 29. Remedial - proposition 7 and the numbering

Which one of the following is correct about proposition 7 of the *Tractatus*?

- A. It is rendered identically in the Ogden and the Pears-McGuinness translations, so no attribution is needed.
- B. It is elaborated in a series of subordinate remarks numbered 7.1 to 7.4 that qualify its scope.
- C. It stands uncommented and alone, and its two standard translations differ, so the rendering should be named.
- D. It states that propositions about ethics and religion are false, since they fail to describe any fact.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Ogden gives "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent" and Pears-McGuinness "What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence"; the difference is exactly why the rendering must be flagged.
- **B:** Incorrect: there is no proposition 7.1. The decimal system means n.1 comments on n, and Wittgenstein deliberately supplies no comment on 7.
- **C:** Correct: it is the single uncommented proposition of the book, and naming the translation is the cheapest provenance mark available in this clause.
- **D:** Incorrect: ethical claims are not factual propositions at all, which is a different and more respectful verdict than declaring them false.

Examiner trap 29: Writing "7.1" is an immediate signal to a specialist examiner that the text has not been handled directly. When unsure of any wording, cite the decimal number instead of the sentence.

MCQ 30. Remedial - the *Tractatus* and the verification principle

Which one of the following correctly states the relation between the *Tractatus* and the verification principle?

- A. The *Tractatus* states the verification principle and the Vienna Circle merely restated it in a clearer form.
- B. The *Tractatus* asks whether a proposition depicts a possible situation, while verificationism asks whether it can be empirically checked.
- C. The *Tractatus* rejects the verification principle by name and offers meaning as use in its place.
- D. The *Tractatus* accepts the verification principle for empirical statements and rejects it for mathematical ones.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the Circle drew an empiricist criterion of significance out of Tractarian resources; the transformation is theirs, and attributing it to the text is a marked error.
- **B:** Correct: possible depiction and empirical checkability are different tests, and the difference is why "The Absolute is perfect" and "there is an undetectable object" fail for different reasons in the two systems.
- **C:** Incorrect: meaning as use belongs to the *Philosophical Investigations* and to Topic 08, and the *Tractatus* nowhere discusses the Circle's principle.
- **D:** Incorrect: no such split appears; mathematical propositions are treated as equations that show rather than say, not as exceptions to a verification criterion.

Examiner trap 30: This is the single most common way of ending a Topic 06 answer inside Topic 07. Draw the boundary in one sentence and stop.

MCQ 31. Remedial - the attribution boundary

Which one of the following belongs to this syllabus clause rather than to another owner?

- A. Moore's act/object distinction, which blocks the identification of a sensation with its object.
- B. Moore's naturalistic fallacy, which charges that goodness has been identified with a natural property.
- C. Wittgenstein's family resemblance, which explains how a general term can apply without a common essence.
- D. Strawson's theory of persons, which treats the concept of a person as logically primitive.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: it is the instrument of "The Refutation of Idealism" (1903), a printed limb of this clause, and it is also what Russell takes over for sense-data.
- **B:** Incorrect: the naturalistic fallacy belongs to *Principia Ethica* (1903) and to ethics - same author, same year, different subject, and not printed in this clause.
- **C:** Incorrect: family resemblance is a doctrine of the later philosophy and belongs to Topic 08, along with language-games and the private-language argument.
- **D:** Incorrect: Strawson's persons belong to Topic 11; he appears here only as the author of one objection to the theory of descriptions.

Examiner trap 31: This clause names three thinkers and seven doctrines, which makes attribution itself examinable. Losing a mark by importing Moore's ethics is avoidable in a single clause of scope-setting.

MCQ 32. Remedial - how far descriptions support atomism

Which one of the following correctly states the strength of the link between the theory of descriptions and logical atomism?

- A. The theory of descriptions entails logical atomism, since eliminating a description exhibits an atomic fact.
- B. The theory of descriptions is independent of logical atomism, since the two belong to different phases of Russell's work.
- C. The theory of descriptions refutes logical atomism, since contextual definition shows that no expression designates a simple.
- D. The theory of descriptions supports logical atomism by removing pseudo-constituents, without proving that analysis terminates.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: eliminating an apparent constituent shows what is *not* there; it neither exhibits a simple nor demonstrates that a final base exists.
- **B:** Incorrect: the two are closely connected - 1905 supplies the technique that the 1918 programme applies - and both questions in 2018 and 2024 turn on that connection.
- **C:** Incorrect: contextual definition applies to incomplete symbols, not to genuine names, so it leaves the possibility of designating simples entirely open.
- **D:** Correct: it separates grammatical subjects from genuine logical constituents and so makes the atomist search reasonable, while leaving termination, identification and exhaustiveness unproved.

Examiner trap 32: Both 2018 Q4(c) and 2024 Q3(a) ask *how* the one leads to the other. Asserting entailment is the standard overclaim; "supports but does not prove" is the sentence that earns the assessment mark.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answers for Philosophy Paper I. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the printed anomalies the repository ledger flags. The 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 Paper I texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below - including the three supporting parts owned by other topics - follows the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger. Moore and Russell are cited by **paper and year**; the *Tractatus* is cited by **decimal proposition number**, and where a translation is quoted the translator is named. Interpretive disputes - the standard ineffability reading against the resolute reading of 6.54, whether logical constructions are genuine phenomenalist reductions, whether the theory of descriptions is a quantificational device or a deeper account of apparent names - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands are **10 marks - about 150 to 200 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 300 words**, and **20 marks - about 340 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: this clause owns **14 of 112** Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus - **joint-highest** with Rationalism and Existentialism - and it owns **at least one part in every year**. All fourteen are solved in full below, followed by **three supporting routed parts** that name the trio but are owned by Topics 03 and 08, and **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal distribution is worth knowing before the exam: **Moore** owns five parts, **Russell** owns six, and **early Wittgenstein** owns three, so a candidate who prepares only the *Tractatus* has prepared roughly a fifth of the clause.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: How does Wittgenstein apply the distinction between 'saying' and 'showing' to point to a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy? Is he justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How does he apply... Is he justified?" - an application followed by an explicit verdict with reasons
Core issue	That one structural error generates the whole family of philosophical problems
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: derive the distinction, apply it to three problem-families, then assess
Ideal thesis	Every decisive philosophical problem is an attempt to say what can only be shown
Non-negotiables	The derivation from the picture theory; 4.1212; the ladder at 6.54; the two readings; a graded verdict

Independent model answer

Thesis. The distinction is not one doctrine among others in the *Tractatus* but a diagnostic instrument: applied across philosophy, it reveals that the decisive problems share a single structure - each attempts to state a condition of stating.

The derivation. A proposition depicts by sharing logical form with a possible situation. To depict that sharing, a further picture would have to stand outside logical form; but every picture already has logical form, and a regress threatens any attempt. Hence "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212).

The application, in three families. *Metaphysics* tries to state the form of the world - "there are objects" - and produces nonsense (*unsinnig*) rather than falsehood. *Logic* tries to state its own truths as substantive claims, whereas tautologies are senseless (*sinnlos*) and show the scaffolding of the world (6.124). *Ethics and aesthetics* try to state value, which lies outside the world (6.41-6.421); "there is indeed the inexpressible; this shows itself; it is the mystical" (6.522).

The single way. Each family attempts the same illegitimate move, so the correct method is not to answer these questions but to show that the questioner has given no meaning to certain signs (6.53).

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Justified as a diagnosis, because it is derived rather than stipulated and unifies problems previously treated as unrelated. CAUTION: Not fully justified as a doctrine, since the *Tractatus*'s own propositions fail its test - 6.54 concedes the ladder - and the standard ineffability reading and the resolute reading of Diamond and Conant still divide over whether anything remains to be shown.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question contains the word "single", so the answer must produce a *unification*, not three separate applications.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis two lines; derivation four; three families six; single way two; verdict four.

- **Structure:** derive -> apply across three families -> state the unification -> grade the verdict.
- **Doctrine:** logical form as presupposed by all depiction; *sinnlos* against *unsinnig*; value outside the world.
- **Evidence:** 4.1212, 6.124, 6.41-6.421, 6.522, 6.53, 6.54.
- **Distinction:** nonsense is not falsehood, and senselessness is not nonsense.
- **Criticism:** self-application, with the two readings named rather than merged.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2018 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: How is Russell's theory of definite description related to his Logical Atomism? Discuss and give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How is X related to Y... give reasons" - a stated relation, defended, and bounded
Core issue	Whether descriptions support, entail or merely accompany atomism
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the technique, the ontological pay-off, and the exact limit of the support
Ideal thesis	Descriptions make atomism reasonable by removing pseudo-constituents; they do not prove it
Non-negotiables	The three conjuncts; "genuine constituent" as the operative notion; the 1918 residue; the honest limit

Independent model answer

Thesis. The theory of descriptions is the working demonstration that analysis can remove an apparent constituent of a proposition; logical atomism is the ontology one is entitled to expect if that removal can be carried out systematically. The relation is therefore **evidential support**, not entailment.

The technique. "The F is G" is analysed as $(Ex)[Fx \ \& \ (Ay)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$. The phrase "the F" is an **incomplete symbol**: it has no meaning in isolation, is given a contextual definition, and disappears under analysis. What remains are universals and logical apparatus.

The bridge to atomism. Atomism holds that the world consists of facts, that atomic facts contain no further facts as constituents, and that analysis terminates in **logical, not physical, atoms** - "the last residue in analysis" (1918). Descriptions supply the method by which a residue is reached in a particular case: they separate grammatical subjects from **genuine logical constituents**, which is exactly the discrimination atomism needs.

Why the support falls short of proof. ANALYSIS: Removing one class of pseudo-constituents does not show that every analysis terminates, does not identify the simples, and does not establish that reality is exhaustively atomic. Russell's own inventory shifted, and he admitted negative facts as a truth-making cost.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Descriptions are the scalpel; atomism is the anatomy the surgeon expects to find. The instrument has proved permanent; the anatomy was never completed - which is why the honest answer states support and withholds entailment.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "give reasons" converts this from a description into an argument about strength of connection. Naming the connection *support*, *not entailment* is the marks-bearing move.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis three lines; technique four; bridge five; limit four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** state the relation -> the technique -> the bridge -> the limit -> the verdict.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; contextual definition; atomic facts; logical residues.
- **Evidence:** "On Denoting" (1905); the 1918 lectures and the "last residue" formulation.
- **Distinction:** genuine constituent against grammatical subject.
- **Criticism:** no proof of termination; unfixed simples; the negative-fact cost.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2019 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: Why is Moore's philosophy called common-sense realism?

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Why is it called..." - justify a label, both halves of it
Core issue	What is <i>common-sense</i> about the method and what is <i>realist</i> about the content
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the method, the content, and what the label does not license
Ideal thesis	The label is earned by a method of comparison and by the content of the truisms, not by an independently argued metaphysics
Non-negotiables	The truisms; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; the hands proof; the qualification that realism is a result

Independent model answer

Thesis. Both halves of the label are earned, but by different things: "common sense" describes Moore's **method**, and "realism" describes the **content** of what that method defends.

Why "common sense". In "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) Moore lists ordinary propositions - that he has a body, that the earth existed for many years before his birth, that there are other human beings with bodies - and claims to *know* them, adding that very many others know propositions of the same kind. He then separates **knowing that a proposition is true** from **knowing its correct analysis**, so that unresolved difficulty about what a material object is cannot be used to deny that we know we have hands. The method is comparison: a philosophical argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism it denies.

Why "realism". The propositions defended include the existence of a body, of the earth before one's birth and of other human beings - items whose existence does not consist in being perceived. The 1939 lecture makes this explicit by glossing "external" as "things met with in space" and proving that at least two such things exist.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: The realism is a **result**, not a premiss: Moore offers no theory of perception, leaves the relation between sense-data and material objects unsettled, and supplies no neutral measure by which the comparison of certainties could be adjudicated. WRONG: Nor is "common sense" an appeal to popular opinion - the list is a philosophical proposal and is contestable.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The label is accurate provided both qualifications are stated; without them it suggests a systematic realist metaphysics that Moore never wrote.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "why is it called" question is a definition question in disguise. Justify each word of the label separately, then say what the label does not license.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis two lines; common sense six; realism four; qualification four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** split the label -> method -> content -> qualification -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** truisms; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; things met with in space.
- **Evidence:** 1925 and 1939 papers, kept separate.
- **Distinction:** popularity against ordinary knowledge; result against premiss.
- **Criticism:** no neutral measure of certainty; no theory of perception.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2020 · Q2(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically discuss the following statement by Moore: "If anyone tells us that to say 'Blue exists' is the same thing as to say that 'Both blue and consciousness exist', he makes a mistake and a self-contradictory mistake."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically discuss" a quotation - locate it, decode it, then assess
Core issue	Why the identification is not merely false but self-contradictory
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: paper and target, the decoding of "self-contradictory", the act/object argument, the residual
Ideal thesis	The idealist must deploy the very distinction he claims makes no difference
Non-negotiables	1903 <i>Mind</i> ; <i>esse est percipi</i> ; act and object; transparency; the bounded conclusion

Independent model answer

Location. The sentence is from "The Refutation of Idealism" (*Mind*, 1903), and its target is the equation **to be is to be perceived (*esse est percipi*)** as it functions in Berkeleyan idealism.

Why the mistake is a mistake. The idealist inference requires that a sensation and its object be one thing. Moore argues that they cannot be: the sensations of blue and of green must have something **in common**, since both are sensations, and must **differ**, since their objects differ. On the identity thesis there is only one item in each, so nothing is available to play both roles. Hence "consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either".

Why it is self-contradictory. The claim is that "Blue exists" and "Both blue and consciousness exist" say the same thing. But the second statement is formed by **conjoining two distinct items**. To assert that the two statements have the same content, the speaker must already possess and use the distinction whose significance he denies. The identification therefore cannot be stated without presupposing its own falsity.

The diagnosis. Consciousness is **transparent** or diaphanous: attention passes through the act to the object, so the act seems elusive. ANALYSIS: Elusiveness is not absence, and the argument above does not depend on isolating the act introspectively.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The charge bites hardest against a strict **identity** formulation. An idealist who claims that blue is *dependent on* consciousness without being identical with it has not been convicted of contradiction - he has been deprived of the argument he had. ANALYSIS: And the distinction, once drawn, shows only that the object is not constituted by the act; unperceived existence needs a further argument.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the examiner has printed a specific charge - *self-contradictory* - and the answer must explain that word, not merely paraphrase the sentence.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: location two lines; the mistake five; the self-contradiction five; diagnosis two; assessment four.

- **Structure:** locate -> the structural argument -> decode "self-contradictory" -> transparency -> residual.
- **Doctrine:** act/object; common and variable elements; diaphanousness.
- **Evidence:** *Mind*, 1903; the blue-green-consciousness sentence.
- **Distinction:** identity against dependence.
- **Criticism:** the dependence formulation survives; unperceived existence is not established.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2020 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: "The reason that I call my doctrine logical atomism is because the atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms." Write a note on the nature of atomic facts according to Russell in the light of the above statement.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Write a note... in the light of the above statement" - the quotation controls the structure
Core issue	What an atomic fact is, once "atomic" has been defined by analysis rather than by size
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: decode the quotation, give the structure of atomic facts, the molecular layer, the cost
Ideal thesis	Atomism is a claim about where analysis stops, not about how small things are
Non-negotiables	"Last residue in analysis"; particular + quality or particulars + relation; truth-functionality; negative facts

Independent model answer

Decoding the quotation. Three phrases carry the doctrine. "Last residue **in analysis**" makes atomism a claim about a **method**: an atom is whatever survives when analysis has removed every complexity. "**Logical**... not physical" locates the atoms among the constituents of facts - particulars, qualities and relations - not among small bodies. And "my doctrine" signals an ontology read off a **logic**, not off a physics.

The structure of an atomic fact. An atomic fact contains **no other facts as constituents**. It is either monadic - a particular exemplifies a quality, as in "this is red" - or relational, as in "this is to the left of that". ANALYSIS: It plainly *has* constituents; what it lacks is facts among them, and reading "atomic" as "partless" is as damaging as reading it as "microscopic".

Fact and proposition. Facts are **truth-makers**, not truth-bearers: a fact is not true, a proposition is. A true atomic proposition corresponds to an atomic fact, and the two share logical structure - names correspond to objects and the arrangement of names to the arrangement of objects. Molecular propositions are **truth-functions** of atomic ones, so no fact in the world answers to "and" or "or".

The cost. ANALYSIS: True negations such as "Socrates is not alive" appear to require something to make them true, and Russell reluctantly admits **negative facts**. The admission adds absences to the inventory, and he accepts it to preserve a direct truth-making relation.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Atomic facts are the logical terminus of a method rather than an inventory Russell claims to have completed; the programme's method is durable, its base was never fixed, and the negative-fact concession shows the price being paid openly.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a quotation-controlled question is graded on whether the quoted words are actually used. Decode the phrases before expounding the doctrine.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: decoding five lines; structure four; fact and proposition four; cost three; verdict two.

- **Structure:** decode -> structure of the atomic fact -> the language-world correspondence -> cost -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** analysis-relative atomism; monadic and relational facts; isomorphism; truth-functionality.
- **Evidence:** the 1918 lectures and the quoted sentence.
- **Distinction:** truth-maker against truth-bearer; logical against physical; atomic against partless.
- **Criticism:** negative facts; unfixed simples.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2021 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: What are the main arguments put forward by Moore in his paper "A Defence of Common Sense" to prove that there are possible propositions about the world that are known to be true with certainty? Do you think Moore's arguments provide a sufficient response to objections presented by the sceptic against the possibility of knowledge? Give reasons in support of your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: expound the arguments, then rule on sufficiency with reasons
Core issue	Whether a comparison of certainties can answer a sceptical argument
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: three arguments, the deductive form of 1939, the objection, three replies, a graded verdict
Ideal thesis	Sufficient as a redistribution of burden, insufficient as a refutation
Non-negotiables	The list; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; the three conditions of proof; the question-begging objection

Independent model answer

The three arguments of the 1925 paper. *First*, the **list of truisms**: that there exists a living human body which is his body, that it has existed continuously on or near the earth, that the earth existed for many years before he was born, that there have existed many other human beings with bodies. Moore asserts not merely that these are true but that he **knows** them, and adds the second-order claim that very many others know propositions of the same kind - which converts the defence from a report of personal confidence into a claim about a shared epistemic position.

Second, the **level distinction**: knowing that a proposition is true is one question, and knowing its correct **analysis** is another. Whether a material object is a substance, a class of appearances or something else may remain unsettled without disturbing the knowledge that one has two hands. The sceptic who argues from analytic difficulty to ignorance commits a confusion of levels.

Third, the **comparison of certainties**: since an argument transmits credibility backwards as well as forwards, a valid argument whose conclusion is less credible than its premisses is one that has refuted a premiss. Moore's claim is that no sceptical premiss has ever been more certain than the truism it is used to deny.

The 1939 continuation. "Proof of an External World" turns the same strategy into an explicit deduction, with three stated conditions - the premiss must differ from the conclusion, must be known rather than believed, and must entail it - while conceding that the premiss cannot itself be *proved*.

The sceptic's objection. The proof begs the question: the second condition is exactly what the sceptical argument denied.

Three replies, and the verdict. Moore's own reply is comparative: he need not establish the premiss from neutral ground, only show that it outweighs its rivals. **ANALYSIS:** A dialectical reply, developed by later defenders, holds that the proof shows the *cost* of scepticism. **ANALYSIS:** **CAUTION:** A third and different diagnosis - that such propositions function as framework certainties rather than ordinary knowledge-claims - belongs to *On Certainty* and to Wittgenstein's later philosophy, not to Moore.

Verdict. **ANALYSIS:** **Sufficient** as a redistribution of dialectical burden: the sceptic must now defend his premisses instead of assuming that abstract premisses defeat perceptual ones. **Insufficient** as a refutation: no neutral measure of comparative certainty is supplied, so a sceptic who denies that Moore knows the truism has been outweighed rather than shown to be irrational.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question says "arguments", plural, and then asks a yes-or-no question. Three named arguments and an explicitly graded verdict are what the wording demands.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: three arguments twelve lines; the 1939 continuation three; objection two; replies four; verdict four.

- **Structure:** three arguments -> the deductive form -> objection -> three replies -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** truisms and the second-order claim; the level distinction; comparative certainty; the three conditions.
- **Evidence:** 1925 and 1939 papers, correctly separated.
- **Distinction:** outweighing an argument against refuting it.
- **Criticism:** the missing neutral measure, stated as the reason for the "insufficient" half.
- **Owner control:** *On Certainty* named in a clause and left to Topic 08.

Solved PYQ 7 · 2021 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: What does Wittgenstein mean by the statement - "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent?" Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"What does he mean... critically discuss" - exposition with translation discipline, then assessment
Core issue	Why the "must" is a logical consequence and not a counsel of prudence or reverence
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the translation, the derivation, what falls silent, the ladder, the two readings
Ideal thesis	Silence follows from the account of sense; the alternative to silence is not error but noise
Non-negotiables	Naming the translation; 4.1212; 6.53; 6.54; the standard/resolute split; no proposition 7.1

Independent model answer

The sentence. This is proposition 7, in the Ogden translation; Pears-McGuinness render it "What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence". ANALYSIS: Proposition 7 is uncommented and stands alone - there is no 7.1 - and naming the rendering matters because the two differ.

What it means. The "must" is **logical**, not prudential. A proposition has sense by depicting a possible situation through shared logical form. Where there is no possible situation to depict, an utterance does not become risky or imprecise; it fails to be a proposition at all. There is therefore nothing to be careful about and nothing to get wrong.

What falls on the silent side. Logical form itself, since any depiction of it would presuppose it - "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212). The existence of objects. The propositions of logic, which are senseless (*sinnlos*) and show the scaffolding of the world. And value: "the sense of the world must lie outside the world" (6.41); "there can be no propositions of ethics" (6.42); "there is indeed the inexpressible; this shows itself; it is the mystical" (6.522).

The method that follows. 6.53 states the corollary: say nothing except what can be said, and whenever someone attempts a metaphysical statement, demonstrate that he has given no meaning to certain signs.

Critical discussion. ANALYSIS: The doctrine is not a dismissal: ethical claims are not declared **false**, and they are not declared unimportant. CAUTION: But it is self-applying. The *Tractatus*'s own sentences fail its test, and 6.54 concedes it - the reader who understands them recognises them as nonsensical and throws away the ladder. The **standard** reading treats this as an honest acknowledgment that something manifests itself; the **resolute** reading of Diamond and Conant denies that any ineffable truth remains. ANALYSIS: The graded verdict is that silence is correctly derived, while the status of the derivation itself remains the book's unresolved problem.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: most scripts treat proposition 7 as a mood. Establishing that the "must" is logical is the single move that separates a strong answer from a competent one.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: sentence and translation three lines; meaning four; what falls silent five; method two; criticism five.

- **Structure:** name the translation -> derive the "must" -> list the silent side -> 6.53 -> the ladder and the two readings.
- **Doctrine:** sense as depiction; showing; value outside the world.
- **Evidence:** 4.1212, 6.41, 6.42, 6.522, 6.53, 6.54, 7.

- **Distinction:** not-sayable against false; *sinnlos* against *unsinnig*.
- **Criticism:** self-application, with both readings named and a ruling given.

Solved PYQ 8 · 2022 · Q1(b) · 10 marks

Question: What is Bertrand Russell's method of logical analysis? How does it ultimately end in establishing atomic theory of meaning? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part in ten marks: state the method, then trace its terminus
Core issue	How a method of paraphrase generates an ontology and a theory of meaning
Scope boundary	Ten marks: method in three moves, terminus in two, one qualification
Ideal thesis	The method is the exposure of logical form; its terminus is the atomic base it presupposes
Non-negotiables	Grammatical against logical form; descriptions; constructions; atomic and molecular propositions; the honest limit

Independent model answer

The method. Russell's logical analysis rests on one principle: **grammatical form need not be logical form**. It proceeds in three moves. First, **contextual elimination** - a definite description is an incomplete symbol and is replaced by existence, uniqueness and predication, so that "The F is G" becomes $(\exists x)[Fx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Gx]$. Second, **construction** - where a philosopher would infer an unknown entity, Russell substitutes a construction out of known ones, following his supreme maxim of 1914. Third, **resolution** - every remaining complex proposition is exhibited as a truth-function of simpler ones.

The terminus. Applied without remainder, the method must stop somewhere. Its stopping point is the **atomic proposition**, which states an **atomic fact** containing no other facts as constituents - a particular exemplifying a quality, or particulars in a relation. Meaning is therefore atomistic: the significance of any sentence is fixed by the atomic propositions into which it resolves and the truth-functional operations applied to them, since the connectives name nothing.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: The method makes this terminus reasonable rather than proved: Russell never identified the simples, admitted negative facts as a truth-making cost, and found belief-contexts resistant to truth-functional treatment.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the words "ultimately end in establishing" invite an overclaim. The mark is earned by tracing the route *and* refusing the entailment.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: method five lines; terminus four; qualification two.

- **Structure:** principle -> three moves -> terminus -> limit.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; constructions; truth-functional resolution.
- **Evidence:** 1905, 1914 and 1918.
- **Distinction:** meaning fixed by atoms against meaning conferred by connectives.
- **Criticism:** unidentified simples; negative facts; belief-contexts.

Solved PYQ 9 · 2022 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: Is there any difference between pictorial form and logical form in Ludwig Wittgenstein's picture theory of language? How does the logical form define the relation between language and reality? Explain.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: a yes/no on the difference, then an explanation of a relation
Core issue	That logical form is the universal case of which pictorial forms are the species
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the ontology in brief, the contrast, the relation, and the consequence
Ideal thesis	Logical form is what every picture must share with reality; it therefore makes the language-world relation internal
Non-negotiables	1.1 and the states-of-affairs ontology; 2.18 and 2.182; the medium/universal contrast; showing

Independent model answer

Yes - the two differ, and the difference is one of generality. In the *Tractatus* the world is "the totality of facts, not of things" (1.1); a fact is the existence of states of affairs, each a combination of objects. A proposition is a **logical picture**: its elements are correlated with objects, and its arrangement depicts a possible arrangement of them, so it is true if the situation obtains and false if it does not - meaningful either way, because a **possible** configuration is presented.

Pictorial form (Form der Abbildung) is what a picture must share with reality in order to depict it **in its own medium**. A spatial model shares spatial form with what it models; a musical score shares acoustic form with the music. Such a picture can depict only what shares its particular form.

Logical form (logische Form) is the most abstract structural commonality - what **every** picture, in any medium, must share with reality (2.18). Every picture is therefore a **logical** picture (2.182), though not every picture is spatial or musical, and a proposition can depict **any** fact whatever because logical form is the universal medium of representation.

How logical form defines the relation. Because logical form is common to the proposition and to the fact, language and world are not two domains needing an external bridge. The relation is **internal**: sharing form is constitutive of the proposition's being a picture at all, rather than a correlation set up by convention or causation.

The consequence. ANALYSIS: Logical form is not itself a depictable fact - any picture of it would already employ it. It therefore **shows** itself in every meaningful proposition and cannot be **said** (4.1212), which is where the picture theory hands over to the saying/showing distinction.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the second half of the question is a separate demand. An answer that contrasts the two forms and stops has answered half the paper.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: ontology and picturing five lines; pictorial form three; logical form four; the relation three; consequence three.

- **Structure:** ontology -> picturing -> pictorial form -> logical form -> internal relation -> showing.
- **Doctrine:** correlation of elements; depiction of a possible situation; universality of logical form.
- **Evidence:** 1.1, 2.18, 2.182, 4.1212.
- **Distinction:** medium-specific against universal; internal against external relation.
- **Criticism:** the indescribability of logical form, stated as a consequence rather than a defect.

Solved PYQ 10 · 2023 · Q4(b) · 15 marks

Question: Why according to Russell is the proposition - "The present king of France is bald" problematic? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Why is it problematic... critically discuss" - state the problem, the solution, then the rival
Core issue	That an apparently referring subject-term has nothing to refer to
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: three rejected options, the analysis, the puzzles, Strawson
Ideal thesis	The sentence is false, not meaningless, because the analysis is quantificational
Non-negotiables	The three rejected answers; the three conjuncts; scope; Strawson 1950 with a ruling

Independent model answer

The problem. The sentence is grammatically impeccable and is understood by every competent speaker, yet there is no present King of France. If its subject-term is a **name**, then either the sentence is meaningless, or it is about a non-existent object, or the name denotes something unidentifiable. Russell rejects all three: we plainly understand the sentence; Meinong's subsisting objects inflate the ontology and, in the case of the round square, threaten non-contradiction; and no alternative denotatum survives inspection.

The solution. "The present King of France" is an **incomplete symbol** - no meaning in isolation, given a contextual definition, and eliminated on analysis. The sentence asserts $(\text{Ex})[\text{Kx} \ \& \ (\text{Ay})(\text{Ky} \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ \text{Bx}]$: at least one present King of France, at most one, and he is bald. The **existence** conjunct is false, so the whole conjunction is **false** - not meaningless, and committed to no ghostly monarch.

What this also solves. *Negative existentials*: "the present King of France does not exist" is the denial of an existence-and-uniqueness claim and needs no denotation. *Excluded middle*: "the King of France is not bald" is **false** when the description takes wide scope (**primary occurrence**) and **true** when the negation does (**secondary occurrence**), so the apparent failure is a scope ambiguity.

The rival. CAUTION: Strawson's "On Referring" (*Mind*, 1950) holds that a speaker **presupposes** rather than asserts existence, so that when the presupposition fails the question of truth or falsity does not arise. ANALYSIS: Russell can reply that a logic requires truth-conditions and that truth-value gaps carry their own costs. The durable verdict is that Strawson describes ordinary **use** better and Russell describes **logical form** better; the two are rival analyses rather than a refutation.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question asks *why it is problematic*, so the three rejected options must appear before the analysis; otherwise the solution has no problem to solve.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: problem five lines; solution four; further puzzles four; rival four.

- **Structure:** problem and three rejected answers -> analysis -> puzzles -> rival -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; existence, uniqueness, predication; scope.
- **Evidence:** "On Denoting" 1905; Strawson 1950.
- **Distinction:** false against meaningless; assertion against presupposition.
- **Criticism:** Strawson, with an explicit ruling instead of a bare mention.

Solved PYQ 11 · 2024 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: What arguments are offered by Moore to prove that there are certain truisms, knowledge of which is a matter of common sense? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Arguments plus assessment, in ten marks
Core issue	The structure of the 1925 defence, compressed
Scope boundary	Ten marks: three arguments in outline, one qualification, one verdict
Ideal thesis	The arguments establish a burden-shift, not a refutation of scepticism
Non-negotiables	The list; knowing against analysing; comparative certainty; WRONG: not popularity

Independent model answer

Three arguments. *First*, the **list**: in "A Defence of Common Sense" (1925) Moore sets out ordinary propositions - that he has a body, that the earth existed for many years before his birth, that there are other human beings with bodies - asserts that he **knows** them, and adds that very many others know propositions of the same kind. *Second*, the **level distinction**: knowing that a proposition is true is a different question from knowing its correct **analysis**, so unresolved difficulty about what a material object is cannot be converted into ignorance that one has hands. *Third*, the **comparison of certainties**: a philosophical argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism it denies, and Moore claims none has ever been.

Critical assessment. **WRONG**: The doctrine is not an appeal to majority belief; the list is a philosophical proposal and is contestable. **ANALYSIS**: More seriously, the comparison presupposes that certainty can be weighed across ordinary and philosophical propositions without a neutral measure, which Moore does not supply. The arguments therefore shift the burden of proof onto the sceptic without demonstrating that he is irrational.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: ten marks and two demands. Three named arguments in outline, then one real criticism, is the correct allocation; the 1939 proof belongs in a closing clause at most.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: three arguments eight lines; assessment four.

- **Structure:** list -> level distinction -> comparative certainty -> assessment.
- **Doctrine:** truisms; knowing against analysing.
- **Evidence:** the 1925 paper, kept separate from 1939.
- **Distinction:** ordinary knowledge against popular opinion.
- **Criticism:** the missing neutral measure.

Solved PYQ 12 · 2024 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: Explain Russell's notion of incomplete symbols. Also explain how this notion leads to the doctrine of logical atomism.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two explanations, the second a route rather than a claim of entailment
Core issue	How a semantic device becomes an ontological programme
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the notion, the worked case, constructions, atomism, assessment
Ideal thesis	Incomplete symbols supply the technique; constructions apply it; atomism names the expected residue
Non-negotiables	Definition and test; the three conjuncts; the supreme maxim; atomic facts; the honest limit

Independent model answer

The notion. An **incomplete symbol** has **no meaning in isolation** but contributes systematically to the meaning of every sentence in which it occurs, and it **disappears on analysis**. It is defined **contextually** - by rules giving the meaning of whole sentences containing it - a technique Russell takes from *Principia Mathematica*. The test is simple: does the expression survive analysis as a constituent of the proposition? **WRONG:** "Incomplete" does not mean "meaningless"; that is the misreading the theory exists to prevent.

The worked case. "The F is G" is analysed as $(\text{Ex})[\text{Fx} \ \& \ (\text{Ay})(\text{Fy} \rightarrow \text{y} = \text{x}) \ \& \ \text{Gx}]$ - existence, uniqueness, predication. "The present King of France is bald" is therefore **false**, not meaningless, and no subsisting object is required. Three puzzles fall together: negative existentials, the apparent failure of excluded middle, which is resolved as a **scope** ambiguity between primary and secondary occurrence, and the failure of substitutivity in George IV's curiosity about the author of *Waverley*.

The first extension: constructions. The same contextual technique is applied to ontology. Russell's **supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** (1914) directs us to "substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities". Physical objects become classes of actual and possible sense-data; nations become patterns of individual behaviour; numbers become classes of equinumerous classes; points become convergent classes of volumes. Nothing extra is posited, and ordinary sentences remain true.

The second extension: atomism. If pseudo-constituents can be removed and inferred entities replaced, what remains when analysis is complete? Russell's answer is **atomic facts** - containing no other facts as constituents, structured as a particular with a quality or particulars in a relation - stated by **atomic propositions**, with all other propositions their truth-functions. The atoms are "the last residue in analysis", and they are **logical, not physical**.

Assessment. **FACT:** The route is genuine: one technique, applied to propositions and then to ontology, generates the whole programme. **ANALYSIS:** But it is support, not entailment. The analysis does not prove that every analysis terminates, does not identify the simples, and does not establish exhaustive atomism; negative facts are admitted as a cost; belief-contexts resist truth-functional treatment; and Strawson offers a rival account of descriptions. Incomplete symbols are the scalpel; logical atomism is the anatomy the scalpel was cutting toward - and the anatomy was never completed.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "leads to" is the examiner's word, and it is deliberately weaker than "entails". Trace the route in stages and then say precisely how strong the link is.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: notion five lines; worked case five; constructions five; atomism five; assessment six.

- **Structure:** notion -> worked case -> constructions -> atomism -> graded assessment.
- **Doctrine:** contextual definition; the three conjuncts; the supreme maxim; atomic facts and truth-functions.
- **Evidence:** 1905, 1914, 1918; George IV and *Waverley*.
- **Distinction:** incomplete symbol against meaningless expression; support against entailment.

- **Criticism:** unfixed simples, negative facts, belief-contexts, Strawson.

Solved PYQ 13 · 2025 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: "The golden mountain is very high." Discuss this statement in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Discuss in the context of the theory" - the formal analysis is obligatory
Core issue	Whether an empty description makes a sentence meaningless or false
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the problem, the notation, the verdict, one scope remark
Ideal thesis	False, not meaningless, and with no Meinongian object
Non-negotiables	Incomplete symbol; the three conjuncts in notation; Meinong named; the scope point

Independent model answer

The problem. The sentence appears to be **about** something - a golden mountain - and nothing answers to that phrase. If the phrase were a name, the sentence would either be meaningless or would commit us to a non-existent object of the kind **Meinong** admitted; the golden mountain is his own stock example.

The analysis. "The golden mountain" is an **incomplete symbol**: it has no meaning in isolation and disappears on analysis. The sentence asserts $(\exists x)[Gx \ \& \ (\forall y)(Gy \rightarrow y = x) \ \& \ Hx]$ - there is at least one golden mountain, at most one, and it is very high.

The verdict. The existence conjunct is **false**, so the whole conjunction is **false**. The sentence is therefore neither meaningless nor about a subsisting entity, and asserting it commits us to nothing.

Scope. ANALYSIS: "The golden mountain is not very high" is **false** on the **primary occurrence**, where the description takes wide scope, and **true** on the **secondary occurrence**, where the negation does - so the apparent conflict with excluded middle is an ambiguity of scope rather than a defect in logic.

Point. Grammatical form is not logical form: the apparent name was a quantifier in disguise, and analysing it removes an ontological commitment we never had reason to accept.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: this is the clearest case in the clause where the directive **requires notation**. A purely verbal treatment is marked down however fluent it is.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: problem four lines; analysis three; verdict two; scope two; point two.

- **Structure:** problem -> notation -> verdict -> scope -> general point.
- **Doctrine:** incomplete symbols; existence, uniqueness, predication.
- **Evidence:** "On Denoting" 1905; Meinong named as the target.
- **Distinction:** false against meaningless.
- **Criticism:** implicit in the scope remark, which pre-empts the excluded-middle objection.

Solved PYQ 14 · 2025 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either." Present an account of Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Present an account... with reference to this statement" - the quotation must organise the answer
Core issue	How the act/object distinction blocks <i>esse est percipi</i>
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: paper and target, the comparison argument, transparency, the bounded result
Ideal thesis	The identification of act with object is what idealism needs and what the comparison denies
Non-negotiables	1903 <i>Mind</i> ; <i>esse est percipi</i> ; common and variable elements; diaphanousness; the four-part boundary

Independent model answer

Location and target. The sentence is from "The Refutation of Idealism" (*Mind*, 1903). Its target is the principle **to be is to be perceived (*esse est percipi*)**, which requires that the object's being be nothing over and above its being perceived - and therefore that the sensation and its object be one thing.

The argument the sentence states. Every sensation contains an **act of awareness** and an **object of awareness**. The quoted sentence identifies which is which: blue and green are the **objects**, and consciousness is what "both sensations have in common". If awareness were identical with its object, then the sensations of blue and of green would share **nothing**, since their objects differ, and would differ in **nothing further**, since there is nothing else in them. Both consequences are false, so awareness and object are distinct.

The diagnosis. Consciousness is **transparent** or diaphanous: when we introspect the sensation of blue what we find is the blue, and the act is looked *through* rather than at. ANALYSIS: This explains why the conflation is so tempting; it is not itself a premiss of the refutation, and the argument above does not require isolating the act introspectively.

The result, exactly bounded. FACT: *Esse est percipi* is not established, because the identity it requires has been denied on structural grounds. ANALYSIS: It does **not** follow that any object exists unperceived: distinguishing object from act shows only that the object is not **constituted** by the act. ANALYSIS: No theory of perception is offered - Moore leaves the relation between sense-data and material objects unsettled. FACT: And **Absolute Idealism is untouched**, since it argues from internal relations and the incompleteness of finite determinations, not from the perceptual equation.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Moore removes idealism's most economical argument rather than idealism itself; the act/object distinction nevertheless became foundational for analytic philosophy, and Russell took it over for sense-data.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "with reference to this statement" means the quotation must do structural work. Use it to name the common and the variable element, then build the argument from that naming.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: location three lines; argument six; diagnosis three; boundary five; verdict two.

- **Structure:** locate -> target -> comparison argument -> transparency -> four-part boundary -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** act and object; common and variable elements; diaphanousness.
- **Evidence:** *Mind* 1903 and the printed sentence.
- **Distinction:** blocking an argument against proving a metaphysics; Berkeleyan against Absolute idealism.
- **Criticism:** the four things the paper does not achieve, stated as the boundary rather than as a complaint.

SUPPORTING ROUTED PARTS THAT NAME THE TRIO BUT ARE OWNED ELSEWHERE

ANALYSIS: These three parts are **not** counted among the fourteen owned questions. Each names Moore, Russell or Wittgenstein while being routed by the repository ledger to another syllabus item. They are given here with the **contribution this clause makes** and an explicit boundary, so that a candidate can supply the Topic 06 material without answering the wrong question.

Routed part 1 · 2018 · Q3(a) · 20 marks · owned by Empiricism (Topic 03)

Question: How does Berkeley establish that Mind and its ideas alone are real? How do Moore and Russell react to Berkeley's view in this regard? Do you find any difference between Moore's reaction and Russell's one? Discuss.

What Topic 03 owns: Berkeley's own establishment of immaterialism - the attack on abstract ideas, the collapse of the primary/secondary distinction, *esse est percipi*, and the role of God's perception.

What this clause contributes - the comparative half. ANALYSIS: **Moore's reaction is epistemic and distinction-drawing.** In "The Refutation of Idealism" (1903) he denies the identification of the act of awareness with its object, so that *esse* cannot be defined as *percipi*; and in the common-sense papers he protects ordinary certainty by comparing credentials rather than by constructing a rival system. He offers no replacement theory of perception. ANALYSIS: **Russell's reaction is logical and reconstructive.** He accepts that what is directly given is sense-data, and then **rebuilds** the physical world as a **logical construction** out of actual and possible sense-data, under the supreme maxim of 1914; and he removes apparent names by **contextual analysis**, so that ontological commitment is decided by logical form rather than by grammar. He also breaks with Berkeley's nominalism by admitting acquaintance with **universals**.

The difference, in one sentence. ANALYSIS: Both reject Berkeley's conclusion, but Moore blocks the argument and leaves the analysis open, whereas Russell concedes the starting point and supplies a replacement architecture - which is why Moore's answer is a refutation of an inference and Russell's is a reconstruction of the world.

Boundary. WRONG: Do not expound Moore's or Russell's systems at length in an answer whose principal demand is Berkeley's establishment of immaterialism; the comparative half is one substantial paragraph.

Routed part 2 · 2023 · Q4(c) · 15 marks · owned by Later Wittgenstein (Topic 08)

Question: What were the main reasons that led Wittgenstein to shift from picture-theory of meaning to use-theory of meaning? Critically discuss.

What Topic 08 owns: meaning as use, language-games, family resemblance, forms of life, the private-language argument, and the positive account that replaces the *Tractatus*.

What this clause contributes - the "from". FACT: An accurate statement of what was abandoned: sense as the depiction of a possible situation through shared logical form; **bipolarity**; the postulation of simple objects and logically independent elementary propositions; the claim that every proposition is a truth-function of elementary ones; and the general form of the proposition at 6. ANALYSIS: It also contributes the **internal pressures** that are honestly locatable inside the early programme: the **colour-exclusion** problem - "this patch is red all over" and "this patch is blue all over" are incompatible although neither appears to be a truth-function of the other - which Wittgenstein addressed in "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (*PAS Supp.*, 1929) and whose proposed analysis he quickly abandoned; the absence of any uncontested example of a simple object; and the resistance of belief-contexts to truth-functional treatment.

Boundary. ANALYSIS: Colour exclusion diagnoses a pressure; it does **not** by itself establish meaning as use. WRONG: Do not import language-games into a Topic 06 answer, and do not present the *Tractatus* as having anticipated its own replacement.

Routed part 3 · 2025 · Q3(a) · 20 marks · owned by Later Wittgenstein (Topic 08)

Question: "We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise 'logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used." Explain the transition from early views of Wittgenstein to his later views on language and meaning with reference to this statement. **Printed wording:** the unmatched opening quotation before **logical structure** is visible in the official English line and is retained.

What Topic 08 owns: the later account of meaning, and the assessment of whether the transition is an improvement.

What this clause contributes - an accurate portrait of the "ideal language" being rejected. FACT: The *Tractatus* does not propose an ideal language as a reform of ordinary language; it holds that "all the propositions of our everyday language, just as they stand, are in perfect logical order", and that analysis would **reveal** a structure ordinary language already has. ANALYSIS: Stating this prevents the commonest distortion in transition answers - that early Wittgenstein wanted to replace ordinary language with a calculus. What he held was that sense requires a determinate underlying logical form, that the general form of the proposition fixes the limits of the sayable, and that what falls outside is nonsense.

Boundary. ANALYSIS: The printed quotation is a summary of the later position, not a sentence of Wittgenstein's *Tractatus*. WRONG: Do not attribute it to the early work, and do not let a Topic 08 answer become a Topic 06 exposition; two paragraphs of accurate early doctrine are the correct contribution.

Six original questions in the UPSC idiom - two at 10 marks, two at 15 and two at 20 - with complete model answers inside the declared bands. These are learner practice, not past papers.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Explain what Russell means by calling a definite description an "incomplete symbol", and state the test by which such a symbol is identified. Discuss.

Independent model answer

The notion. A symbol is **incomplete** when it has **no meaning in isolation** yet contributes systematically to the meaning of every sentence in which it occurs, and when it **disappears** once the sentence is correctly analysed. Such a symbol is never defined in its own right; it is given a **contextual definition** - a rule that supplies the meaning of whole sentences containing it. Russell takes the technique from the practice of contextual definition in *Principia Mathematica*.

The test. Ask whether the expression survives analysis **as a constituent of the proposition**. "The author of *Waverley*" does not: the analysed sentence contains existence, uniqueness and predication, and no corresponding constituent. A genuine name would survive.

The consequence. Because no constituent corresponds to the phrase, a sentence containing it commits us only to whatever satisfies its predicates. That is why an empty description yields **falsity** rather than meaninglessness, and why the device is an instrument of ontological economy.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: "Incomplete" must never be read as "meaningless": the phrase is meaning-contributing in every context and meaningless only on its own - a distinction on which the entire theory depends.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish between senseless (*sinnlos*) and nonsensical (*unsinnig*) propositions in the *Tractatus*, and explain why the distinction matters. Discuss.

Independent model answer

Senseless (*sinnlos*). Tautologies and contradictions are **well formed** and belong to the symbolism, but they say nothing about the world. A tautology is true under every truth-condition and excludes nothing; a contradiction is false under every truth-condition and excludes everything. They are the **limiting cases** of proposition-formation, and they **show** the scaffolding of logic (4.461-4.4611, 6.124).

Nonsensical (*unsinnig*). A metaphysical pseudo-proposition - "the Absolute is perfect", "there are objects" - fails the conditions of sense altogether. It does not depict any possible situation, so it never entered logical space and there is nothing for it to exclude.

Why the distinction matters. ANALYSIS: First, it fixes the status of logic: logical truth is not a body of very general facts but an absence of factual content, which is why "there can be no surprises in logic" (6.1251). ANALYSIS: Second, it prevents the commonest misreading of the *Tractatus*. If the two labels were synonyms, Wittgenstein would appear to dismiss logic and metaphysics on one and the same ground, and his position would collapse into the Vienna Circle's verificationism - a criterion he did not hold, since his test is whether a possible situation is depicted, not whether a statement can be empirically checked.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Both are ways of failing to say something, and they fail at different points: one inside the symbolism, one before it.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: "Moore's method protects ordinary knowledge at the cost of leaving philosophy without a criterion." Examine this statement.

Independent model answer

What the statement gets right. Moore's defence rests on a **comparison of certainties**: an argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism it denies. That is a genuinely protective device, and it is effective because a valid argument transmits credibility backwards as well as forwards. But the comparison requires a scale, and Moore supplies none. He tells us that "I have a body" is more certain than any sceptical premiss; he does not tell us how the comparison is conducted or what would settle a dispute about it. The 1939 lecture concedes the point in its own way by admitting that the premiss cannot be **proved**, only known.

What the statement understates. ANALYSIS: Two things. First, Moore's method is not merely defensive: the **knowing/analysing distinction** is a substantive epistemological thesis - that propositional knowledge can be secure while the analysis of its constituents is unfinished - and it has to be argued against, not merely disliked. Second, the absence of a criterion is partly the point. Moore's target is precisely the assumption that a philosophical premiss automatically outranks a perceptual one, and demanding a neutral criterion for the comparison would reinstate the priority he is challenging.

The residual. CAUTION: The dispute cannot be closed from within Moore's resources. Later work re-describes propositions like "here is a hand" as **framework certainties** on which doubt itself depends rather than as ordinary knowledge-claims - a diagnosis that vindicates Moore's practice while abandoning his description of it, and one that belongs to Wittgenstein's later philosophy rather than to Moore.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The statement is accurate as a description of what Moore does not provide and misleading as an account of what he was trying to provide: he offers a rule of precedence rather than a criterion of knowledge, and the honest assessment is that the rule works dialectically while remaining unjustified by anything more basic.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Assess the claim that Russell's logical constructions reduce the physical world to sense-data.

Independent model answer

The claim as usually stated. On the strong reading, Russell's 1914 programme is a **phenomenalist reduction**: a physical object simply *is* a class of actual and possible sense-data, so that talk of tables is, at bottom, talk of appearances.

What supports it. The **supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** directs us to "substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities", and Russell's worked case is precisely the construction of a physical object out of classes of sense-data from various points of view. Since acquaintance in this phase reaches sense-data, memory data, introspective data and universals - and not physical objects - the base is unavoidably phenomenal.

What tells against it. ANALYSIS: Three things. First, the maxim is **methodological**: it says what to try before positing, not what reality contains. Second, Russell's parallel constructions are not phenomenal at all - nations from patterns of individual behaviour, numbers from classes of equinumerous classes, points from convergent classes of volumes - which shows the technique to be general rather than a doctrine about perception. Third, the construction requires **possible** sense-data, and unrealised possibilities are not "known entities" in the sense the maxim demands, so the reduction does not straightforwardly succeed on its own terms.

The provenance point. ANALYSIS: Russell's base did not stay fixed. Later **neutral monism** reconceives mental and physical items in terms of neutral events, and it is not a printed limb of this clause. Reading the 1914 constructions as Russell's permanent metaphysics conflates two phases.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The claim is defensible about the **1914 construction of physical objects** and indefensible about **logical constructions as such**. The durable contribution is the technique of contextual construction and the ontological economy it delivers; the phenomenalist inventory was a phase, and its strain point - possible sense-data - was visible from the beginning.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "The *Tractatus* is a book that succeeds by failing." Critically examine this claim with reference to the doctrine of saying and showing.

Independent model answer

The claim, stated precisely. The *Tractatus* offers an account of the conditions under which a sentence has sense, derives from it a boundary around the sayable, and then discovers that its own sentences lie outside that boundary. The claim under examination is that this is the book's method rather than an accident: it succeeds as an elucidation precisely by failing as doctrine.

The derivation that produces the failure. A proposition depicts only by sharing **logical form** with a possible situation. To depict that sharing, a further picture would have to stand outside logical form; but every picture already has logical form, and each attempted statement of form would need its own form stated. Hence "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212). The result extends to the existence of objects, to the logical truths that show the scaffolding of the world (6.124), and to value, since "the sense of the world must lie outside the world" (6.41) and "there can be no propositions of ethics" (6.42).

Why this convicts the book. Every sentence of the *Tractatus* is about logical form, objects, the general form of the proposition and the limits of language. None depicts a contingent state of affairs, so by its own criterion none says anything. Wittgenstein does not conceal this: **6.54** states that anyone who understands him recognises his propositions as nonsensical, having used them as steps to climb beyond them, and must then throw away the ladder.

The two ways of reading the outcome. CAUTION: On the **standard ineffability** reading the failure is productive: something genuinely manifests itself - logical form, value, the mystical - which no proposition could carry. On the **resolute or therapeutic** reading of Diamond and Conant, no ineffable truths remain; the sentences are plain nonsense, and the therapy is the reader's coming to see that he was never given a doctrine.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The claim is largely correct, with one refinement. As a **diagnosis** the book succeeds: it unifies metaphysics, logic and value under one structural error - the attempt to state a condition of stating - and 6.53 converts that diagnosis into a method. As **doctrine** it fails, and the failure is self-inflicted rather than imposed by critics. What the slogan obscures is that "succeeding by failing" is intelligible on only one of the two readings: the standard reading can say what survives, whereas the resolute reading must say that nothing does.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The *Tractatus* succeeds as an activity - philosophy as clarification, 4.112 - and fails as a set of theses; an honest answer names the reading it relies on before calling the failure fruitful.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Compare the logical atomism of Russell with that of the early Wittgenstein, and assess whether the two should be treated as one doctrine.

Independent model answer

Why the comparison is necessary. The syllabus prints "Logical Atomism" once, and both men held a doctrine of that name in the same years - Russell's lectures were delivered in 1918, the *Tractatus* manuscript was completed in 1918, and Russell's own preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein. The temptation to treat them as one doctrine is therefore built into the material, and resisting it is where the marks are.

Axis 1 - what the atoms are. For Russell the atoms are **particulars together with qualities and relations**, identified in this phase through **acquaintance**, with sense-data as the standard case. For Wittgenstein the atoms are **objects**: logical simples whose intrinsic nature is never specified and which are characterised entirely by their **possibilities of combination**, which in turn fix logical space (2.013).

Axis 2 - how they are reached. Russell's programme is simultaneously logical and **epistemological**: analysis is guided by what we can be acquainted with, which is why the theory of descriptions is needed to preserve the Principle of Acquaintance. Wittgenstein's argument is **transcendental-logical**: simples are required because determinate sense requires a final base, and no example is offered because none is needed for the argument.

Axis 3 - independence. Russell acknowledges the logical independence of atomic propositions somewhat loosely. Wittgenstein insists on it **strictly** (2.061, 4.211), because the truth-table method must be exhaustive - and it is exactly this strict commitment that **colour exclusion** later pressures.

Axis 4 - negative facts. Russell reluctantly admits **negative facts** as truth-makers for true negations, treating the ontological cost as the price of a direct truth-making relation. Wittgenstein needs no such category: the **totality** of obtaining states of affairs also determines which possible states do not obtain (2.05), and the logical constants are not representatives (4.0312).

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The two share a form of words and a historical moment, and they share the thesis that the world is factual and that analysis reveals a base. They differ on what the base contains, on how it is reached, on how strictly independence is held, and on whether negation requires an ontological correlate. ANALYSIS: The practical consequence is that the standard criticisms do not transfer: an objection to sense-data does not touch Tractarian objects, and colour exclusion presses on Wittgenstein's strict independence rather than on Russell's looser version.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: They should be treated as **two atomisms with a common ancestry**, not as one doctrine held by two men. A script that merges them will attribute negative facts to the *Tractatus* or sense-data to Wittgenstein's objects - and either error is immediately visible to a specialist examiner.